

User Guide for the "Covers" Program

1. File Locations

- **covers.exe** – The compiled executable file that you run.
 - **config.json** – The configuration file created automatically on first run (and updated when settings change). It is located in the same folder as covers.exe.
 - **config.py** – The configuration script; it must be located alongside covers.exe (it is included during the build process).
 - **fonts folder** – Contains the fonts used by the program (font files must be placed here).
 - **Excel file** – The input file with cover data; you select it via a file dialog when running the program.
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2. What the Program Does

- **Configuration:**
When you launch the program, a configuration window appears where you can modify all layout settings.
 - **File Selection:**
After closing the configuration window, a file dialog appears. You select your Excel file containing cover data.
 - **Processing:**
The program generates cover images according to the configured settings and saves them in an **output** folder located next to the selected Excel file.
 - **Viewing Results:**
The output folder opens automatically after processing, allowing you to view the generated covers.
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3. Configuration Settings

Settings are divided into thematic groups. All values are displayed in a user-friendly format (without underscores, with only the first letter of each option capitalized). You can modify these parameters to fine-tune the cover layout.

3.1 Title Settings

- **Title Area Width Factor (0.8)**
The fraction of the cover width available for the title.
Change: Lower values increase the side margins. Recommended: 0.7–0.9.
 - **Title Max Font Size (120)**
The maximum font size for the title.
Change: For short titles, you can increase this. Recommended: 100–150.
 - **Title Min Font Size (30)**
The minimum font size for the title (for long text).
Change: Should not go below 20–40 to maintain readability.
 - **Title Line Spacing (1.2)**
The line spacing multiplier for the title text.
Change: Values greater than 1 increase the space between lines. Recommended: 1.1–1.3.
 - **Title Top Margin (100)**
The top margin in the title zone.
Change: Increasing shifts the title downward; decreasing moves it upward.
Recommended: 50–150.
 - **Title Zone Percent (30)**
The percentage of the cover height allocated to the title zone.
Change: Determines the space for the title. Recommended: 25–35%.
 - **Title Text Color (255, 255, 224)**
The title text color (light yellow).
Change: Specify an RGB tuple string, e.g., "(255, 255, 224)".
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3.2 Subtitle (Volume) Settings

- **Volume Area Width Factor (0.8)**
The fraction of the cover width available for the subtitle.
Change: Similar to the title width factor; recommended: 0.7–0.9.
- **Volume Ratio (0.8)**
The ratio of the subtitle font size to the title font size.
Change: Lowering this makes the subtitle smaller. Recommended: 0.6–0.8.

- **Volume Min Font Size (50)**
The minimum subtitle font size.
Change: Recommended: 40–60.
 - **Volume Max Font Size (100)**
The maximum subtitle font size.
Change: For short subtitle text, you can increase this. Recommended: 80–120.
 - **Volume Line Spacing (1.2)**
The line spacing multiplier for the subtitle text.
Change: Recommended: 1.1–1.3.
 - **Volume Top Margin (10)**
The top margin for the subtitle zone.
Change: Recommended: 5–20.
 - **Subtitle Zone Percent (25)**
The percentage of the cover height allocated to the subtitle zone.
Change: Recommended: 20–30%.
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3.3 Anchor & Authors Settings

- **Anchor Area Width Factor (0.8)**
The fraction of the cover width available for the anchor text.
Change: Recommended: 0.7–0.9.
- **Authors Area Width Factor (0.8)**
The fraction of the cover width available for the authors' text.
Change: Recommended: 0.7–0.9.
- **Anchor Ratio (0.5)**
The ratio of the anchor font size to the title font size.
Change: Recommended: 0.4–0.6.
- **Anchor Min Font Size (50)**
The minimum anchor font size.
Change: Recommended: 40–60.
- **Anchor Max Font Size (80)**
The maximum anchor font size.
Change: Recommended: 60–100.

- **Author Ratio (0.6)**
The ratio of the authors' font size to the title font size.
Change: Recommended: 0.5–0.7.
 - **Author Min Font Size (70)**
The minimum authors' font size.
Change: Recommended: 60–80 for good readability.
 - **Author Max Font Size (90)**
The maximum authors' font size.
Change: Recommended: 80–120.
 - **Anchor Line Spacing (1.2)**
The line spacing multiplier for the anchor text.
Change: Recommended: 1.1–1.3.
 - **Author Line Spacing (1.2)**
The line spacing multiplier for the authors' text.
Change: Recommended: 1.1–1.3.
 - **Author Zone Percent (20)**
The percentage of the cover height allocated to the anchor/authors zone.
Change: Recommended: 15–25%.
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3.4 Color Settings

- **Other Text Color (255, 215, 0)**
The color for subtitle, anchor, and authors text (gold).
Change: Specify an RGB tuple string, e.g., "(255, 215, 0)".
 - **Background Color (108, 37, 36)**
The background color of the cover (RGB).
Change: For example, "(0, 0, 0)" for black.
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3.5 Additional Settings

- **Logo Size ("400,200")**
The logo size in the format "width,height".
Change: Adjust to change the displayed logo dimensions.

- **Cover Width Cm (15.2)**
The cover width in centimeters.
Change: Affects the final image size; choose based on printing standards.
 - **Cover Height Cm (21.72)**
The cover height in centimeters.
Change: Affects the scale and proportions of the final image.
 - **Resolution (140)**
The image resolution (DPI scale factor).
Change: Increasing improves quality but enlarges file size; select as needed.
 - **Title Font Name ("EuphoriaScript-Regular.ttf")**
The primary font for the title (file must be in the fonts folder).
Change: Select from the dropdown list.
 - **Secondary Font Name ("GreatVibes-Regular.ttf")**
The secondary font for subtitles and additional text.
Change: Select from the list.
 - **Alternative Font ("arial.ttf")**
The fallback font used if the selected fonts are unavailable.
Change: Usually left as default.
 - **Zone Count (4)**
The number of zones in the cover layout.
Change: This value is not used in the new percentage-based zone splitting.
 - **New Zone Splitting:**
 - **Title Zone Percent (30):** Percentage of cover height for the title zone.
 - **Subtitle Zone Percent (25):** Percentage of cover height for the subtitle zone.
 - **Author Zone Percent (20):** Percentage of cover height for the anchor/authors zone.
The remaining percentage is allocated to the logo zone.
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4. How to Use

1. **Launch the Program:**
Run `covers.exe` by double-clicking it.

2. **Configure Settings:**

A configuration window will open displaying all settings grouped by theme.

- Edit any parameters as needed.
- Use the dropdown menus for font selections (text is left-aligned and displays full names).
- To reset settings to factory defaults, click **Reset To Defaults**.
- Click **Run Processing** to save settings and close the configuration window.

3. **Select Excel File:**

After the configuration window closes, a file dialog appears.

- Select your Excel file with cover data.

4. **Processing:**

The program generates cover images based on the configured settings and saves them in an **output** folder located next to the selected Excel file.

5. **View Results:**

The output folder opens automatically after processing.

5. Recommendations

- **Adjust Gradually:**

Modify one or two settings at a time and check the output.

- **Zone Percentages:**

The new zone percentage parameters let you control the relative heights of the zones:

- **Title Zone Percent:** Space for the title.
- **Subtitle Zone Percent:** Space for the subtitle.
- **Author Zone Percent:** Space for the anchor and authors. The remaining percentage is used for the logo zone.

- **Color Settings:**

Colors must be entered as RGB tuple strings (e.g., "(255, 255, 224)"). Adjust these for the desired contrast and look.

- **Font Selection:**

The dropdown includes both fonts from the **fonts** folder and common system fonts.